

docshots: L^AT_EX Package that Renders T_EX Samples Next to Their PDF Snapshots*

Yegor Bugayenko
yegor256@gmail.com

2026-07-15, 0.5.0

The T_EX processor must be invoked with the `--shell-escape` option, and the following must be installed on the host system: `pdflatex`, [Perl](#), [Ghostscript](#), and [pdfcrop](#). The `--shell-escape` option is required because the package launches these external programs from within the T_EX run in order to compile and crop each snippet. The package operates on Windows as well as on Unix, provided these tools are on the `PATH`.

1 Introduction

When demonstrating to the readers of a document how certain T_EX commands are to be employed, the most cogent approach is to display precisely how the entire document will be rendered as a PDF, by means of a subprocess (such as `pdflatex`) that performs the rendering. To the [author's best](#) knowledge, no existing package addresses this need; hence the present, modest package was devised.

For instance, the following code:

```
\begin{docshot}  
\documentclass{article}  
\usepackage{xcolor}  
\pagestyle{empty}  
\begin{document}  
  Hello, {\color{orange}\LaTeX}!  
\end{document}  
\end{docshot}
```

is rendered thus:

Hello, L^AT_EX!	<pre>1 \documentclass{article} 2 \usepackage{xcolor} 3 \pagestyle{empty} 4 \begin{document} 5 Hello, {\color{orange}\LaTeX}! 6 \end{document}</pre>
--	---

*The sources are in GitHub at [yegor256/docshots](#)